Bar Mitzvah Boy

By Samara Siskind

Darkness. A sappy slow-dance song plays faintly in the background. We hear an angry voice in the darkness followed by a slap.

STACIE: **(Pg 15-25)** Hey! *(Lights rise on SAMUEL and STACIE facing each other on a dance floor. They are both dressed in fancy evening attire. SAMUEL clutches his sore face.)*

SAMUEL: Oww! You hit me!

STACIE: Your hand was on my butt.

SAMUEL: My hand was nowhere near your butt!

STACIE: C'mon, Samuel, your hand was totally touching my butt!

SAMUEL: One – I wouldn't touch your butt with a ten-foot pole. Two – Even if I did touch your butt, it's no reason to resort to physical violence.

STACIE: Well, if your hand goes anywhere near my butt again, I'm cutting it off.

SAMUEL: Oh, that's nice. I'm sure they'll let you off on the popular "he touched my butt" defense. Now can we just finish this dance already, please? Everyone's watching. *(Beat. STACIE puts SAMUEL'S right arm high up on her waist, and takes his left hand in hers. They dance rather awkwardly)*

INTRODUCTION

(In a very geeky manner) MY BAR MITZVAH – The huge party when my family announced to the world that I am a Man. A man . . . who girls LOVE! This is how it happened: I make eye contact with the hottest girl in the 7th grade and give my straw a little tongue action so she knows I mean business. A slow song comes on and I strut over to her, not even asking if she wants to dance. I give her the look, and suddenly the two of us engage in a passionate make out session in the middle of the dance floor. Well, maybe that's not EXACTLY what happened. But it's the way I like to remember it . . . Bar Mitzvah Boy by Samara Siskind

SAMUEL: My face is stinging. I can't believe you hit me. It better not leave a mark.

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STACIE: I didn't hit you that hard. Don't be a wuss.

SAMUEL: Don't be a ruffian.

STACIE: Uh, ruffian?

SAMUEL: Savage, bully . . . barbarian.

STACIE: Oh, you're so smart. This is a party, not honors English. *(Beat.)* God, how long is this song?

SAMUEL: It just started.

STACIE: I'm only dancing with you because my mom made me.

SAMUEL: I'm only dancing with you for the photo op. *(SAMUEL smiles, posing for a photographer. Sound of a flash going off)*

STACIE: Just because it's your birthday, doesn't mean you're better than everyone else.

SAMUEL: It's not just my birthday, it's my *Bar Mitzvah*.

STACIE: So?

SAMUEL: So?! *(Proud)* I am a man today.

STACIE: I see no man before me. I see a dork in a beanie.

SAMUEL: It's not a beanie. It's a yarmulke. A religious head covering.

STACIE: Yeah, that makes it cooler.

SAMUEL: I'll have you know, Bar Mitzvah literally translates to "son of commandment" and implies "responsible male."

STACIE: Big whoop.

SAMUEL: Did you hear me read from the Torah?

STACIE: Yeah, and I've got news for you . . . the Torah is a snore-ah.

SAMUEL: You weren't impressed?

STACIE: I was ready to hit the door-ah.

SAMUEL: Gee, thanks.

STACIE: On a scale of one to ten, I give it a four-ah.

SAMUEL: Okay, you didn't like it. I get it. *(Beat. They continue dancing. STACIE scopes*

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out the dance floor SAMUEL is annoyed.) Why did you even come? If you hate me so much.

STACIE: Hello? We've lived next door to each other since we were four, Samuel. My whole family's here. We've had it marked on our calendar since August.

SAMUEL: You could've gotten out of it. You get out of everything else your parents want you to do.

STACIE: Well, maybe I didn't want to get out of it.

SAMUEL: (*Perking up)* Really? Why?

STACIE: No reason.

SAMUEL: There's gotta be a reason. Tell me.

STACIE: Ow!! That's my foot!

SAMUEL: Why'd you want to come, huh? Say it.

STACIE: God, Samuel, what's the big deal?

SAMUEL: C'mom, Stacie, just give it up. Tell me.

STACIE: Okay, fine! You invited Kyle Fischer and Justin Flint. *(Beat. SAMUEL'S spirits plummet once again.)*

SAMUEL: I didn't' invite them. Mom did. She's in the PTA with Mrs. Fischer and did Habitat for Humanity or something with Justin's mom.

STACIE: Do I look like I care? The point is they're here.

SAMUEL: So, what? You're dating them both?

STACIE: Samuel! Hello, I'm twelve.

SAMUEL: But you like them both.

STACIE: One of them likes me.

SAMUEL: Which one?

STACIE: I don't know.

SAMUEL: *(Confused)* If you don't know which one likes you, how do you know if either of them like you?

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STACIE: Jeez, Samuel, you're like clueless. *(Beat)* One of them is my secret admirer.

SAMUEL: Your secret admirer.

STACIE: Valentine's Day was last week, and I got a dozen pink carnations in my locker.

SAMUEL: And you think one of those dorkwads did it?!

STACIE: When I found the flowers in my locker they were at the lockers across the hall . . . looking at me, smiling.

SAMUEL: Oh, and that's like, proof.

STACIE: Shut up.

SAMUEL: You shut up.

STACIE: At least I got something. What did you get for Valentine's Day? Let me guess, a big heart-shaped cookie your mom made you.

SAMUEL: You're so dumb *(Beat)* It was a Cupid.

STACIE: They're looking over here. Oh my God, I'm gonna die. I am so gonna die.

SAMUEL: One – You're not gonna die. And two – They're not looking at you, they're looking at my cousin Sharon. She's seventeen, and a thirty-four double D.

STACIE: Go ask them which one did it.

SAMUEL: Which one did what?

STACIE: Put the flowers in my locker.

SAMUEL: What?! No! No way!

STACIE: C'mon, Samuel, please?!

SAMUEL: I'm not talking to those Neanderthals. Uh-uh.

STACIE: Why not?

SAMUEL: Because one – I'm not your messenger boy, and two – I am enjoying my dance.

STACIE: One – What is with the one and two everything? God. And two – You're just jealous.

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SAMUEL: Of who? Those guys? Please.

STACIE: YOUR HAND'S ON MY BUTT!!!!

SAMUEL: Sorry, it slipped!

STACIE: *(Breaking free)* That's it, Bar Mitzvah boy. Sone of commandment or not, my dad is gonna kick your ass!

SAMUEL: *(Holding on to her)* Wait! Wait. Stacie, I'm sorry. Look, if you leave me up here by myself, Mom is gonna make me dance with my little sister. It'll be more embarrassing than that life-size photo of me in the lobby. Please. *(A popular, upbeat song begins to play)*

STACIE: Fine, but only 'cause I like this song. *(Beat)* Don't touch me. *(They dance without touching, more awkwardly than the slow dance).* You're a really bad dancer.

SAMUEL: I've taken dance lessons at Arthur Murray since October.

STACIE: You should get your money back.

SAMUEL: They never got to fast tempo.

STACIE: Seriously, you look like Milton Smidel when he had that epileptic seizure during bio.

SAMUEL: Yeh, well, you're no Fergie either.

STACIE: I'm sure Kyle and Justin would disagree.

SAMUEL: Kyle and Justin are a few brain cells shy of being mentally retarded.

STACIE: Samuel!

SAMUEL: Haven't you heard the rumors? They like, still eat their boogers.

STACIE: Take it back!

SAMUEL: And they're in love with each other.

STACIE: They are not!

SAMUEL: Look, they're dancing together! See? *(Waving)* Hi, guys! You look super!

STACIE: *(Trying to cover his mouth)* Samuel, sshhh!

SAMUEL: Like they could even figure out your locker combination, yeah, as if. How

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would they even know pink carnations are your favorite flower?! *(Beat. Stacie stops dancing)*

STACIE: How did ***you*** know pink carnations were my favorite flower? *(A few beats. The song changes to another slow one. Stacie puts Samuel's hand on her waist. They start to slow dance again.)* It was you, wasn't it? My secret admirer.

SAMUEL: No.

STACIE: Samuel.

SAMUEL: I mean, well . . . yeah. Kind of. *(Beat)* Kyle and Justin saw me put them in there, hence the staring.

STACIE: Why?

SAMUEL: They thought they were trick flowers that were gonna squirt you in the face.

STACIE: No, I mean . . . why'd you do it?

SAMUEL: I dunno. It's kind of obvious, don't you think?

STACIE: But we haven't . . . I've been so . . . *(Beat)* I haven't been very nice to you.

SAMUEL: Yeah, true dat.

STACIE: Well then, why? *(Beat)*

SAMUEL: When we were in third grade, Bobby Proctor wanted to fight me after school because I wouldn't let him cheat off me. After he threw the first punch you stepped in and kicked him in the balls. He never touched me again after that.

STACIE: I don't remember that.

SAMUEL: I never forgot it. *(A few beats)*

STACIE: Well, thank you. I mean, for the flowers.

SAMUEL: You're welcome. *(Beat)* Y'know . . . I know I'm not cool, or popular enough for you or anything. But I just wanted to do something nice to pay you back for that day and . . . well, 'cause you deserve it.

STACIE: *(Smiling)* Who knew Samuel Rosenbaum could be so sweet?

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SAMUEL: *(Shrugging)* I am a man today. I've matured.

(Stacie wraps her arms around Samuel's neck. They continue to dance even closer together, but both still a bit shy. They sway back and forth to the music. After a few beats)

STACIE: *(Soft)* Samuel.

SAMUEL: *(Dreamlike)* Yeah?

STACIE: Your hand's on my butt again.

SAMUEL: Sorry.

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